MIL-F-44143(GL)
19 March 1985

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FOOD PACKET, ASSAULT, ASSEMBLY OF

This specification is approved for use by Natick Research and Development Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers the assembly requirements for the Food Packet, Assault.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

L-P-560	-	Fork, Knife, and Spoon, Picnic Plastic
L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
Z-C-2104	-	Candy and Chocolate Confections
EE-M-101	-	Matches, Safety: and Matches, Nonsafety (Strike-Anywhere)
QQ-A-1876	-	Aluminum Foil
SS-S-31	-	Salt, Table

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8970

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HHH-C-575 - Coffee, Instant
JJJ-S-791 - Sugar, Refined and Brown: Beet or Cane
MMM-A-250 - Adhesive, Water-Resistant (for Closure of Fiberboard Boxes)
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-C-10022 - Chewing Gum
MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit; Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items, General Specification for
MIL-C-43338 - Cream Substitute, Dry, Non-Dairy
MIL-P-43988 - Paper, Toilet, Tissue (Packet in Sheet Form)
MIL-B-44135 - Beverage Base: Orange Compressed - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-O-44136 - Oatmeal Cookies and Granola Bars, - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-C-44137 - Chicken A La King, Cooked, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-S-44138 - Chicken and Rice, Cooked, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-V-44139 - Vermicelli with Meat and Sauce, Cooked, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-B-44140 - Beef Stew, Cooked, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-E-44141 - Escalloped Potatoes with Pork, Cooked, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-P-44146 - Packaging of Food Packet Assault Components (in Pouches)
MIL-P-44147 - Pudding, Dehydrated - (Operational Ration Component)
MIL-C-44148 - Chicken Stew, Cooked, Dehydrated- (Operational Ration Component)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

Laws and Regulations

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting
D 1238 - Flow Rates of Thermoplastics by Extrusion Plastometer
D 1505 - Density of Plastics by Density Gradient Technique

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

NATIONAL MOTOR FREIGHT TRAFFIC ASSOCIATION, INC., AGENT

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

UNIFORM CLASSIFICATION COMMITTEE, AGENT

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

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2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Components.

3.1.1 Meal bag. The meal bag shall be made from polyethylene tubing that is approved for food use and is 0.010 to 0.012-inch thick, with a density of 0.910 to 0.929 g/cm^3. No area of the bag, including gel-induced depressions, shall be less than 0.010-inch thick. The color of the polyethylene shall conform to number 20040, 20045, 30045, 20062, 24052, 34052, 24064, 34079 through 34102, or 24087 of FED-STD-595. The inside dimensions of the bag shall be 7-1/8 inches wide by 11-7/8 inches long (± 1/8 inch). The bag opening shall be across the width. The bag manufacturer's seal shall be a minimum 1/8 inch wide and located with the outside edge of the seal 1/2 inch (± 1/16 inch) from one end of the bag. The seal shall form a hermetic closure. The entire bag shall show no leakage when tested as specified in 4.2.1.6. The average seal strength of each seal shall be not less than 9 pounds per inch of width and no individual specimen shall be less than 7 pounds (see 4.2.1.5). A 1/4 to 3/8 inch deep slit or V-shaped tear notch shall be located at one end of the bag within 1/2 inch of the longitudinal center line of the bag.

3.1.2 Accessory packet. The accessory packet shall be fabricated in accordance with 3.1.2.1 or 3.1.2.2.

3.1.2.1 Preformed packet. The preformed accessory packet shall be fabricated from material made by hot-extruding or laminating a minimum of 0.001-inch thick polyethylene on 0.00035-inch thick (± 10 percent) aluminum foil and laminating the opposite side of the foil to 0.0005-inch thick (± 20 percent) polyester. The color of the exterior (polyester) side of the laminate shall conform to number 30045, 30099, 30108, 30111, 30117, 30118, 34052, 24064, 34079, 34086, or 34087 of FED-STD-595. Any difference in gloss caused by the polyester exterior layer will be considered acceptable. The inside dimensions of each packet shall be 3-3/4 inches wide by 6-7/8 inches long (± 1/8 inch). Each packet shall be heat sealed on three edges with 3/8 inch wide (± 1/8 inch) seals. The open end of the packet shall be across the width. A 1/8 inch wide (± 1/16 inch) lip shall be incorporated at the open end of the packet. A tear nick or notch shall be located 1 to 1-1/4 inches down from the open end of the packet on the outer edge of one or both side seals. Each tear nick or notch shall be a minimum 1/16 inch deep, but shall not extend into the side seal to a depth that reduces the seal width to less than 1/8 inch. The minimum seal strength of the packet seals shall be 4 pounds per inch of width when tested in accordance with 4.2.1.3.

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3.1.2.2 Formed-fill-seal packet. The formed-fill-seal accessory packet shall consist of a tray-shaped body with a heat sealable cover. The tray-shaped body shall be formed by drawing flexible laminated barrier material into an appropriately shaped cavity. The cover shall be applied by a continuous hermetic heat seal along the entire surface perimeter of the tray-shaped body. The tray-shaped body of each packet shall be fabricated from 0.0015-inch thick linear low density polyethylene bonded to 0.0005-inch thick aluminum foil with 7 pounds per ream low density polyethylene extrusion resin and 0.00075 inch thick oriented polypropylene bonded to the opposite side of the aluminum foil with 10 pounds per ream low density polyethylene extrusion resin. The cover of each packet shall be fabricated from 0.0015 inch thick linear low density polyethylene bonded to 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil with 7 pounds per ream low density polyethylene extrusion resin and 0.0005 inch thick polyester bonded to the opposite side of the aluminum foil with 10 pounds per ream low density polyethylene extrusion resin. The linear low density polyethylene shall be the copolymer of ethylene and octene-1, having a melt index range of 0.8 to 1.2 g/10 minutes in accordance with ASTM D 1238 and a density range of 0.918 to 0.922 g/cm^3 in accordance with ASTM D 1505. The color of the exterior side of the laminates, (polypropylene side of the tray-shaped body and the polyester side of the cover) shall be as specified in 3.1.2.1. The outside dimensions of each packet shall be 3-5/8 inches wide by 5-5/8 inches long ($\pm$ 1/16 inch). The maximum thickness of the filled and sealed accessory packets shall be approximately 5/8 inch. The closure seal at the perimeter of the packet body and cover shall be a minimum of 1/4 inch wide. A tear nick or notch shall be placed on one or both outside edges of the packet length or width to effect easy opening of the packet in the machine direction of the packet body and cover laminates. The tear nick or notch shall be located 3/4 inch ($\pm$ 1/16 inch) from the outside edge of the end or side of the packet. Each tear nick or notch shall be a minimum 1/16 inch deep, but shall not extend into the side seal to a depth that reduces the seal width to less than 1/8 inch. Alternatively, if the packet has serrated edges, the serrations may be used as tear notches provided that the serrations are located to effect easy opening in the machine direction of the packet laminates; the serrations are sharp (no plastic tailings exist); and the serration depth and minimum seal width at the serrations are as specified for the tear nick or notch. The sealed packet shall not show any evidence of material degradation, aluminum stress cracking, or delamination from packet forming or heat sealing.

3.1.3 Menu components. The components required for menu assembly shall be as specified in table I.

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TABLE I. Menu components

Component	Document reference	Used in menu No.
Beef stew	MIL-B-44140	2
Chicken A La King	MIL-C-44137	4
Chicken and rice	MIL-C-44138	5
Chicken stew	MIL-C-44148	1
Escalloped potatoes with pork	MIL-E-44141	3
Vermicelli with meat and sauce	MIL-V-44139	6
Oatmeal cookie bar and granola bar	MIL-O-44136	All menus
Orange beverage bar	MIL-B-44135	All menus
Pudding bars:	MIL-P-44147	
Vanilla	Type I	1
Chocolate	Type II	4
Fig bars	1/	3, 4, 5, and 6
Beef jerky	2/	1, 3, 4, and 6
Pepperoni sticks	3/	2 and 5
Candy:	Z-C-2104 4/	
Chocolate, sweetened, enriched with toffee	Type VII, style 1	1, 3 and 5
Caramels	Type III	2
Fudge bar	Type I, class 2, style 1	2, 4, and 6
Spoon	L-F-560, type IV, item 9	All menus
Accessory packet	3.1.4	All menus

1/ Fig bars shall be Nabisco Fig Newton Cakes. Two fig bars each weighing 1 ounce shall be unit packed in a laminated pouch in accordance with MIL-P-44146. If wrapped with commercial wrap, tear or puncture end of wrap nearest pouch opening, prior to pouch sealing, to allow excess air to be evacuated.

2/ Beef jerky shall be Smokecraft, Inc., product code 1350. Slices of beef jerky weighing 30 to 40 g shall be unit packed in a laminated pouch in accordance with MIL-P-44146.

3/ Pepperoni sticks shall be Smokecraft, Inc., product code 2500. Three-inch long pepperoni sticks, weighing 30 to 40 g shall be unit packed in flat configuration in a laminated pouch in accordance with MIL-P-44146.

4/ Two enriched, sweetened chocolate bars, six caramels (packaged two wide, three long), and one fudge bar shall individually be unit packed in laminated pouches in accordance with MIL-P-44146.

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3.1.4 Accessory packet components. The components required for accessory packet assembly shall be as specified in table II.

TABLE II. Accessory packet components

Component	Document reference
Coffee, instant	HHH-C-575, type I, style I, composition 2
Cream substitute	MIL-C-43338
Sugar	JJJ-S-791, type I, class (a), 6-gram envelope
Salt	SS-S-31, iodized, 4-gram envelope
Chewing gum	MIL-C-10022, type I, flavors 1 or 2
Matches	EE-M-101, type II, class 2
Toilet tissue	MIL-P-43988

3.2 Accessory packet assembly. One each of the components indicated in table II shall be inserted in an accessory packet as specified in 3.1.2. Excess air entrapment shall be avoided during closure sealing. When a preformed packet is used (see 3.1.2.1), the closure seal shall be located above the tear nicks or notches. When a formed-fill-seal packet is used, components shall be placed in the tray-shaped body and the cover applied by heat sealing (see 3.1.2.2). The minimum seal strength of the packet closure seals shall be 4 pounds per inch of width when tested in accordance with 4.2.2.3. The sealed accessory packets shall not leak when tested as specified in 4.2.2.2.

3.3 Meal bag assembly. The required components as indicated in table III shall be assembled and inserted into the meal bag such as to occupy the minimum amount of space while maintaining a flat configuration. Excess air shall be expelled prior to closure sealing with heat such as to allow packing of the meal bags without damaging the meal bag or components therein. The closure seal shall have an average seal strength of not less than 9 pounds per inch of width and no individual specimen shall have a seal strength of less than 7 pounds (see 4.2.4.3). The sealed meal bag shall not leak when tested in accordance with 4.2.4.1.

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TABLE III. Menu contents

Menu No. and components therein	Menu No. and components therein
Menu #1	Menu # 2
Chicken stew	Beef stew
Beef jerky	Pepperoni
Granola bar and oatmeal cookie bar	Granola bar and oatmeal cookie bar
Chocolate bars with toffee	Fudge bar
Vanilla pudding bar	Caramels
Orange beverage bar	Orange beverage bar
Spoon	Spoon
Accessory packet	Accessory packet
Menu # 3	Menu # 4
Escalloped potatoes with pork	Chicken A La King
Beef jerky	Beef jerky
Granola bar and oatmeal cookie bar	Granola bar and oatmeal cookie bar
Chocolate bars with toffee	Fig bars
Fig bars	Fudge bar
Orange beverage bar	Chocolate pudding bar
Spoon	Orange beverage bar
Accessory packet	Spoon
	Accessory packet
Menu # 5	Menu # 6
Chicken and rice	Vermicelli with meat and sauce
Pepperoni	Beef jerky
Granola bar and oatmeal cookie bar	Granola bar and oatmeal cookie bar
Fig bars	Fig bars
Chocolate bars with toffee	Fudge bar
Orange beverage bar	Orange beverage bar
Spoon	Spoon
Accessory packet	Accessory packet

3.4 Plant qualification. The product shall be packaged under sanitary conditions in accordance with good manufacturing practice. The product shall be processed in establishments meeting the sanitary requirements of the applicable Government inspection agency. The meat components shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

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3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1.1 Material certification. Material listed below shall be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certificate of conformance to the indicted requirements.

Requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure
Meal bag material:		
Identification	3.1.1	Laboratory evaluation
Thickness	3.1.1	Laboratory evaluation
Color	3.1.1	Visual evaluation
Accessory packet material:		
Identification	3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2	Laboratory evaluation
Polyethylene, linear low density polyethylene, polypropylene and polyester film thickness	3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2	As specified in L-P-378, except that a machinist's micrometer may be used provided that its graduations and accuracy conform to the requirements of L-P-378.

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Aluminum foil thickness	3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2	As specified in QQ-A-1876
Color	3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2	Visual evaluation

4.2.1.2 Unfilled preformed accessory packet examination. The unfilled preformed packets shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in packets. The sample unit shall be one unfilled packet. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE IV. Unfilled preformed accessory packet defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Not formed as specified
152		Inside dimensions not as specified
153		Tear, hole, or split
154		Foreign odor
155		Evidence of delamination
156		Markings missing, incorrect, or illegible
157		Not heat sealed on three edges
	201	Heat seal width not as specified
	202	Tear nick or notch missing or not located as specified
	203	Dimension of tear nick or notch not as specified
	204	Lip missing or not located at open end
	205	Lip not dimensions specified
	206	Not clean

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4.2.1.3 Unfilled preformed accessory packet seal strength testing. The unfilled preformed packets shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with method A or B of ASTM D 882 except that testing speed may be 10 to 12 inches per minute. The lot size shall be expressed in packets. The sample size shall be the number of packets indicated by inspection level S-1. Three adjacent specimens 1/2 or 1 inch wide, shall be cut from each of the three sealed sides of each packet in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. Any test specimen failing to meet the seal strength requirements specified in 3.1.2.1 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.1.4 Unfilled meal bag examination. The unfilled bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table V. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE V. Unfilled meal bag defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Not formed as specified
152		Inside dimensions not as specified
153		Seal width (bottom) not as specified
154		Distance from outside edge of bottom seal to end of bag not as specified
155		Markings missing, incorrect, or illegible
156		Tear, hole, or split
157		Foreign odor
	201	Tear notch or slit missing or not positioned as specified
	202	Dimensions of tear notch or slit not as specified
	203	Not clean

4.2.1.5 Unfilled meal bag seal strength testing. The unfilled bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with Method A or B of ASTM D 882 except that testing speed may be 10 to 12 inches per minute. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by

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inspection level S-1. Three adjacent specimens 1/2 or 1 inch wide, shall be cut from the sealed side of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. The average seal strength of the bag seal shall be calculated by averaging the strengths of the three test specimens cut from that seal. Any test specimen failing to meet the individual specimen seal strength requirement specified in 3.1.1 or any seal failing to meet the average seal strength requirement specified in 3.1.1 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.1.6 Unfilled meal bag seal leakage testing. The meal bags shall be tested for leakage of the manufacturer's seal. The sample shall be the number of unfilled bags indicated by inspection level S-2. Each sample bag shall be filled with a test load, have excess air expelled, and have a closure seal applied to the open end. The test load shall be fiberboard or other rigid material which is approximately the dimensions of the menu contents. The sample bag shall then be submerged in water in a desiccator or other suitable container under a vacuum of 15 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage. Any sign of leakage shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.2.2 Accessory packet inspection.

4.2.2.1 Accessory packet examination. The filled and sealed preformed packets or formed-fill-seal packets, shall be examined for the defects listed in table VI. The lot size shall be expressed in packets. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE VI. Accessory packet defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Not heat seal closure
152		Dimensions not as specified 1/
153		Tear, hole, or open seals
154		Evidence of delamination 2/
155		Contents caught in closure seal
156		Packets bulging (excess entrapped air)

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TABLE VI. Accessory packet defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
157		Closure seal extends into or below tear nick or notch 3/
158		Packet body not formed as specified 2/
159		Crushed (adversely affecting contents)
160		Markings missing, incorrect, or illegible 2/
161		Not clean 4/
162		Closure seal width not as specified
	201	Tear nick, notch, or serrations missing or not located as specified 2/
	202	Dimensions of tear nick, notch, or serrations not as specified 2/

1/ Applicable to outside dimensions for formed-fill-seal packet only.

2/ Applicable to formed-fill-seal packet only.

3/ Applicable to preformed packets only.

4/ The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Two or less specks of dried product each of which measure 1/8 inch square or less.

b. Any foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential packet damage and which readily falls off when packet is lifted and shaken lightly.

4.2.2.2 Accessory packet leakage testing. The filled and sealed accessory packets shall be tested for leakage by submerging in water contained in a desiccator or other suitable container under a vacuum of 15 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated

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by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage. Any packet with one or more leaks shall be counted as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in packets. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.2.2.3 Accessory packet closure seal strength testing. The filled and sealed packets shall be tested for closure seal strength in accordance with Method A or B of ASTM D 882 except that testing speed may be 10 to 12 inches per minute. For the preformed accessory packets three adjacent specimens, 1/2 or 1-inch wide, shall be cut from the closure seal of each packet in the sample. For the formed-fill-seal accessory packets, three adjacent specimens 1/2 or 1 inch wide, shall be cut from each side and each end of each packet in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width. Any test specimen failing to meet the seal strength requirements specified in 3.2 shall be counted as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in packets. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

4.2.2.4 Accessory packet and contents examination. The contents of the filled and sealed packets shall be examined for the defects listed in table VII. (This examination may be performed on the preformed packets after filling and prior to sealing). The lot size shall be expressed in packets. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed packet. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.0 for major A defects, 2.5 for total major defects, and 2.5 for minor defects.

TABLE VII. Accessory packet and contents defects

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	
101			Missing component (each missing component shall be scored a defect)
	151		More than one component item, as applicable (each item in excess of one shall be scored a defect, such as, one required, three in bag, results in two defects).

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TABLE VII. Accessory packet and contents defects (cont'd)

Category			Defect
Major A	Major B	Minor	
	152		Chewing gum, or matches, as applicable, crushed limiting serviceability (chewing gum may be broken but not crumbled)
	153		Tear or hole in envelope of coffee, cream substitute, sugar, or salt.
	154		Presence of flex fractures in the aluminum foil 1/
		201	Toilet paper not secured by paper band
		202	Component not clean (such as, but not limited to stain, smear, any other foreign matter, etc) 2/

1/ Applicable to formed-fill-seal packets only. To test for flex fractures, the inside surface of the tray-shaped body shall be placed over a light source and the outside surface observed for the passage of light. Observation of light through the packet material in the form of a curved or straight line or a closely clustered group of pinpoint specks of light (three or more specks within a 3/16 inch diameter circle) shall be evidence of the presence of flex fractures in the aluminum foil.

2/ The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Two or less specks of dried product each of which measure 1/8 inch square or less.

b. Any foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential packet damage and which readily falls off when component is lifted and shaken lightly.

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4.2.3 Shipping container inspection.

4.2.3.1 Shipping container examination. Examination of the filled and closed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the examination criteria of the appendix of PPP-B-636 except that the closure examination shall be in accordance with 4.2.3.3. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination:

Major - National stock number, item description, contract number or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
- Metal fasteners used in closing the box.

Minor - Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.

4.2.3.2 Adhesive secured sleeve joint examination. The adequacy of the adhesive secured sleeve joint shall be determined by lifting the filled shipping container and sleeve as one unit. This shall be accomplished by placing the flange of a metal angle iron under the center of the flap of the sleeve and lifting vertically until it is free of the surface on which it was resting. Separation of a flap shall constitute a defect. The metal angle iron shall be bent at an angle of 90° and the flange shall be approximately 5 by 3 by 1/8 inch. The lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 10.0.

4.2.3.3 Flap closure examination. The adequacy of the flap closure shall be determined by lifting the container vertically by each of the outer closed flaps in turn. This shall be accomplished by placing the flange of a metal angle iron under the center of the outer flap of the shipping container and lifting the container vertically until it is free from the surface on which it was resting. Separation of the flap shall constitute a defect. The metal angle iron, sample unit, inspection level, and AQL shall be as specified in 4.2.3.2.

4.2.3.4 Shipping container interior examination. The filled and sealed shipping containers shall be examined for the defects listed in table VIII. The lot size shall be expressed in shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed shipping container. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

TABLE VIII. Shipping container interior defects

Category	Defect
Major	
151	More or less than 12 meals
152	Not two of each menu

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TABLE VIII. Shipping container interior defects (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
153	Contents loose (not snug-fitting)
154	Not packed or arranged as specified
155	Liner missing
156	Liner not material specified
157	Height of box liner less than inside depth dimension of box by more than 1/8 inch or extends above top edge of box

4.2.4 Meal bag inspection.

4.2.4.1 Meal bag leakage testing. The filled and sealed meal bags shall be tested for leakage by submerging in water contained in a desiccator or other suitable container under a vacuum of 15 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a steady progression of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage. Any bag with one or more leaks shall be counted as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed meal bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.2.4.2 Meal bag examination. The filled and sealed meal bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table IX. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed meal bag. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects. The sample meal bags shall be selected from shipping containers which have been filled and closed.

TABLE IX. Meal bag defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Menu component missing
152		Incorrect menu assortment
153		Not arranged as specified

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TABLE IX. Meal bag defects 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
154		Excess air remaining in bag after final closure
155		Not heat seal closure
156		Closure seal width not as specified
157		Not clean - the meal bag or any of the outer packaging of its contents 2/
158		Tear, hole, or puncture in accessory packet or menu component
159		Crushed or broken entree bars or slices (as applicable), granola bar or oatmeal cookie bar, fig bars, fudge bar, chocolate bars, orange beverage bar or pudding bar adversely affecting its contents 3/
160		Crushed or broken accessory packet adversely affecting its contents
161		Broken spoon
	201	More than the required number of components

1/ Examination of meal bags shall be made after shipping container is filled, closed, sleeved, and reinforced (see 4.2.3).

2/ The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Water spots.

b. Two or less specks of dried product each of which measure 1/8 inch square or less.

c. Any foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential pouch damage and which readily falls off when packet is lifted and shaken lightly.

d. Very thin film of grease, oil, or product residue which is discernible to touch but not readily discernible by visual examination.

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3/ Examination for crushed product shall be performed on closed component pouches. A pouch containing crushed or broken components shall be indicated by a depression or bump when the pouch is passed through the fingers while exerting sufficient finger grip pressure to feel the serrated areas, by a movement of any particles felt through the pouch, or by a permanent wrinkling of the pouch material over the meal component. Also, a crushed dehydrated component is one in which 1/8 inch or more of the volume of the product has been reduced to crumbs or powder.

4.2.4.3 Meal bag closure seal strength testing. The filled and sealed meal bags shall be tested for closure seal strength in accordance with Method A or B of ASTM D 882 except that testing speed may be 10 to 12 inches per minute. Three adjacent specimens, 1/2 or 1-inch wide, shall be cut from the closure seal of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound per inch of width for each specimen and for the average of the three specimens from each closure seal. Any individual specimen or any closure seal average failing to meet the seal strength requirement specified in 3.3 shall be counted as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed meal bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

4.2.5 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Twelve meals, two of each menu of table III shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box with sleeve, constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-SL, grade V2s of PPP-B-636, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the closure of the flaps and adequacy of the closure shall be determined by examination as specified in 4.2.3.3 Inner flaps of the box may be closed with two strips of hot melt adhesive per flap, provided the closure meets the examination specified in 4.2.3.3. In addition, the inside of each box shall be provided with a box liner constructed of V3c fiberboard. The height of the box liner shall be equal to the full inside depth of the box (+0 inch, -1/8 inch). As an alternative to body joint metal fasteners, adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250, applied in accordance with the "adhesive joint" requirement of PPP-B-636, may be used to secure the manufacturer's joint of the V2s box. As an alternative to sleeve joint metal fasteners, adhesive conforming to MMM-A-250 may be used for securing the joint, except the overlap shall be a minimum of 3 inches wide. The adhesive sleeve joint shall meet the examination criteria of 4.2.3.2. The adhesive shall cover a minimum of 90 percent of the sleeve overlap area. Meal bags shall be packed on edge, 2 in length, 6 in width and 1 in depth. Alternatively, the filled and sealed meal bags may be arranged within the shipping container in the following manner. Two bags shall be positioned end-to-end against each side panel of the container. One long edge of each bag shall be against the container bottom. The bags shall overlap each other slightly, to fit within the container. Eight filled and sealed bags shall be placed between the four bags at the container side panels. Each of the eight

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bags shall be positioned with one long edge against the container bottom and the ends against the sides of the bags at the container side panels. Boxes shall be reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except pressure-sensitive adhesive filament reinforced tape is prohibited and boxes shall be reinforced with two girthwise straps positioned to divide the box into units of equal length.

5.2 Unit loads. The Food Packet Assault, packed as specified in 5.1, shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with type I, class B of MIL-L-35078.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Meal bag. Each meal bag shall be printed on at least one face in permanent ink in clear black letters not less than 3/16 inch high, as follows:

FOOD PACKET ASSAULT

MENU NO. (1 through 6, as applicable)

_____

(Name of entree component as listed in table I, component column)

(Name and address of assembler)

Continuous printing is acceptable provided that the complete markings appear uninterrupted on at least one face of the bag.

5.3.2 Accessory packet. Each packet shall be printed on one or both sides in permanent ink, in clear black letters as follows:

ACCESSORY PACKET
(letters not less than 1/4 inch high)
(List of accessory packet components shown in table II)
(letters not less than 3/16 inch high)

(Name and address of assembler)

5.3.3 Shipping containers. Shipping containers for complete Food Packets, Assault shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and as specified in the contract with the following exceptions:

a. Identification markings normally placed on an end of the shipping container will be placed on the corresponding end of the sleeve. Contract data and other required markings will be placed on the side of the shipping container to the right of the marked end of the sleeve (when sleeve is positioned on the shipping container).

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b. The top of the sleeve shall be marked "FOOD PACKET, ASSAULT" in letters not less than 1-1/4 inches high.

c. The bottom end of the sleeve as well as the bottom of the case shall convey the box maker's compliance markings as required.

5.3.4 Unit loads. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078 and as specified in the contract.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When accessory packets are procured by the Government the procurement agency should specify shipment to the assembly point as indicated in 6.2.

6.2 Shipment of accessory packets to ration assembler. Accessory packets shall be packed in containers which are acceptable to common carriers for safe transportation to the destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest rate for such supplies. Shipping containers shall be in accordance with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and as specified in the contract.

Custodians:

Army - GL

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
DP - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8970-A146

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-F-44143(GL)	FOOD PACKET, ASSAULT, ASSEMBLY OF

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NATICK OP, 1 Apr 84

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